The relationship between humans and natural ecosystems is not all negative. Over the last decade, public awareness of nature's contributions to people, and our reliance on many of these contributions, has grown. For example, nature provides pollination services, food, water, nutrients, clean air, and even disease and climate management services. Vice versa, many indigenous peoples and local communities have lived in harmony with nature for hundreds of years. There is now a growing commitment from many governments across the world to use these benefits both responsibly and sustainably.



The Eden Project, in Cornwall, UK, simulates a rainforest ecosystem in one of its giant dome greenhouses. The domes' panels are slanted to absorb plenty of light and thermal energy.